CPE Concordia
Educational Program

1185 St. Mathieu Suite I 102
Montreal, Quebec
H3H 2H6
Tel: 514 848-2525 Ext: 8789
cpe.concordia@concordia.ca

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CPE Concordia Educational Program

Educational philosophy

Our educational program is based on the idea that children learn through play. This is how they develop and improve their physical and motor, emotional, social, cognitive, creative and language skills. Adult-child relationships greatly promote the development of learning skills during play, habits, and transition periods. To encourage children's playful exploration, the physical environment is organized to meet the needs, interests, style, and abilities of each person within a group.

We apply this philosophy in an environment focused on the well-being of children, as opposed to an environment led by educators. This makes it possible to devote more time to concrete, free and interactive activities, interspersed with activities supervised by educators (e.g. circles). The program plans to alternate calm activities with more active ones in a reasonably balanced manner, interspersed with periods of indoor and outdoor play, with all the children, in small groups or individually. We aim for the integral development of the child and use play to stimulate all the mechanisms that contribute to their growth. Each child is considered a person who grows and flourishes at their own pace and in their own way. Adapted to the age and progress of children, our program also allows them to participate in activities with friends of all ages. We insist on maintaining good relationships between parents, children, and childcare staff. Finally, the CPE Concordia strives to offer an environment that is warm, educational, fun, and safe while reassuring parents. Communication between educators and parents regarding their child's well-being is very important and is encouraged daily. During the morning, at the end of the day, educators take advantage of a good opportunity to take stock of their child's day.

Preparation for School

Daycare provides the ideal opportunity to prepare for the cognitive, social, emotional, and physical demands on children necessary for their success in kindergarten and later in life.

CPE Concordia is a pre-socialization program with specific goals and objectives intended to prepare the child and family for school and many life experiences. Our goal is to introduce parents to the different areas of development and how the child, parent and educators play a key role in the success of their child's well-being. Their skills and development are influenced by their family and their interactions with peers, educators, and the surrounding community. This collaboration is crucial and necessary before entering school and making their experience a great success in life and for further learning.

Here are some of the key elements necessary for a successful entry into school.

• Parents support their child in their daily learning, constantly, until their transition to kindergarten and until their final years.
• Develop the child's abilities to be independent (dressing, going to the toilet, eating) and his autonomy.
•Communication; be able to express their needs.
• Socialization; be interactive with peers and develop relationships.
• Participate in daycare activities, visit libraries, museums, shows.
• Ready to participate in daily academic curriculum provided by educators that cover the four major areas of development: social, emotional, cognitive, and physical.
• Develop the confidence and self-esteem needed to make safe and intelligent choices.
• Develop curiosity about learning and their environment and have an awareness of their surroundings
• It is important that parents read to their child every day and stimulate their growth through play.
• Continue to participate in their child's daily experiences.
• Have a positive attitude towards school and encourage learning with enthusiasm and curiosity.

Implementing a positive and well-structured daycare program is beneficial for a successful transition to school.

The Importance of Play

Children like to choose the activities they engage in. By letting the child choose a game that targets their current interests, you allow them to have a stress-free experience and give free rein to their imagination.
In addition, the game set up by the child respects his or her pace of development. This rhythm being different from one child to another, the child who takes the initiative in a game avoids finding himself in a situation of failure: the game therefore makes him feel competent, which strengthens his confidence in him.
Play is the main tool through which the child learns. By playing, he discovers the world around him and acquires mastery over certain elements of his environment. Play is essential to the child's overall development and thus constitutes the best preparation for entering kindergarten.

Overall child development

Child development is a holistic and integrated process. It is a process that takes place in each of the domains at the same time (physical and motor, language, social and emotional, cognitive). All areas influence each other and integrate with each other to form a whole: the child.

Physical and motor development

The child lives and interacts within his environment with his senses and his whole body. Physical and motor development refers to:
• physiological needs (food, sleep).
• health and safety.
• sensory development (sight, touch, hearing, etc.).
• Gross and fine motor skills.
• The body schema (awareness of the positions and movements of one's body, the place it occupies in space, etc.).
The more the child's locomotion skills (walking, crawling, running, etc.) and their fundamental movement skills (throwing, catching, kicking, etc.) develop, the more their ability to explore their environment increases. broaden, which helps him to develop his learning in other areas of his development.
To promote healthy lifestyle habits in young children, it is essential to provide them daily, indoors, and outdoors, with several opportunities to play active games, for example:
• Do yoga and Zumba movements
• Dance to your favorite music

• Play ball
• Learn to ride a tricycle
• Organize a small obstacle course or treasure hunt.
Adults also need to balance screen time and active play. Time spent on active play during early childhood tends to decrease in favor of sedentary or low-intensity activities. For more information, please consult the page on balanced screen use among young people.

Social and emotional development

Social development and emotional development are closely linked since they both rely on the bond of attachment that the child forms with his parents and other adults who care for him. The young child is above all a social being who develops through contact with others. Thus, warm, stable, and secure relationships will promote the child's self-confidence and his motivation to explore his environment, because he will know that he can count on caring adults to help him if necessary. Social and emotional development allows the integration of young children into community life. Throughout early childhood, the child is encouraged to become familiar with the rules of life, to understand their usefulness and to apply them. Over the years, the child will be able to:

• To build harmonious relationships with others.
• To communicate one's emotions in a socially acceptable way.
• To consider the perspective of others before acting.
• To resolve conflicts.
• To cooperate and actively participate in group life.

Cognitive development

Cognitive development allows the child not only to acquire knowledge, but also to understand the world around them. To do this, the child must develop various skills such as attention, memorization, reasoning, and planning which will allow him to structure his thinking.
These bases will also allow him to awaken:
• When reading (following a story that the adult tells them).
• Writing (discovery of scribbles).
• Science (asking questions about the world around you).
• Mathematics (discover numbers, shapes).

Cognitive development occurs naturally with daily support from adults. The parent can in particular:

- Play with your child in a way that enriches the content of the game (for example by offering them new, slightly more difficult challenges).

• Take a moment every day to tell him stories.
• Offer various outings (cultural, in nature, etc.), to help him discover new things (music, painting, flowers, animals, etc.) and thus stimulate his curiosity.

Language development

In young children, communication is primarily non-verbal. Verbal language develops gradually, with the ability to understand progressing more quickly than the ability to speak. Verbal language allows the child to enter relationships with others, which thereby contributes to nourishing their social and emotional development.
The adult supports the child's language development first by talking to him, the child needing to hear talk to learn to speak in turn.
Other simple ways you can use to help your child develop language include:

- Establish eye contact with him and give him time to express himself.
- Encourage him to communicate by asking open-ended questions.
- Explain to him the meaning of the new words.
- Rephrase his words with simpler vocabulary if he seems to have difficulty understanding what is said to him.
- Play with language using songs and nursery rhymes.

Finally, regarding creative development, the Center stimulates children's creativity and imagination by cultivating in them an aesthetic sense of music, art, and theater.

Child's Educational File

Educational childcare services are now required to keep an educational record for each child with the aim of:
• Encourage exchanges with the parent.
• Support the detection of difficulties, if necessary.
• Facilitate the various transitions. Each year, the daycare service must send the parent, no later than December 15 and June 15, a periodic portrait of the child's development.
• The portrait presents an overview of the state of development in the physical and motor, cognitive, language, social and emotional domains.
• The evolution of the child's development can be observed from one portrait to another.
• The portrait is not a report card and does not contain targets to achieve.
• The daycare service must meet with the parent, if they request it, to discuss the portrait of their child.
• The partnership between the daycare service and the parent is essential to the harmonious development of the child.

Confidentiality

• The parent's authorization is necessary for the transmission of the educational file to a third party.

The periodic portrait presents an overview of the state of the child's development in each area. Its content is based on daily observations made at the educational childcare service.

The integration

The transition from the summer program to the fall program is important for the early childhood center and is approached carefully.
All new children are encouraged to have two visits to the Early Childhood Center before the start of the fall program. These visits will introduce the child to their class and educator(s). It is hoped that through this gradual integration, these children will be ready to attend full-time once the new session begins.

Basic activities

These activities meet the primary needs of children. The snack, lunch, rest and hygiene are in fact as important for their development and well-being as any other activity. Children develop healthy eating habits, behavior, hygiene, and autonomy. The CPE allocates enough time to this type of activity to allow children to carry them out at their own pace. Furthermore, children learn to wash their hands regularly to prevent any illness or contamination. These activities are ideal opportunities for children to acquire good lifestyle habits. Meals and snacks are also good times to develop autonomy and a sense of competence in children, who can learn to feed themselves, use utensils, unwrap, or peel food on their own. Napping at daycare therefore contributes to the development of the child's cognitive functions. Complementing nighttime sleep and rest periods during the day are also essential to the development of young children.

Food

Educators must above all focus on the pleasure associated with the discovery of new foods, on perception through the senses and on the origin of foods rather than on their nutritional value and their effects on health. Activities aimed at classifying foods as "good" or "bad" should be avoided. Likewise, educators must be made aware of the fact that they must not pass on to children their own beliefs or concerns regarding food.

PRACTICES TO PREFER
• Offer meals and snacks at regular times, spaced 2 to 3 hours apart
• Allow sufficient time for meal and snack periods

• Arrange meal areas in a friendly manner adapted to the needs of children
• Promote discussions and a pleasant atmosphere during meals
• Establish privileged contact with the child during meals, thus promoting learning about the act of eating
• Gradually encourage children to feed themselves, by offering them challenges that match their abilities

Establish rules of conduct at meals for each age group
• Introduce and stimulate reflection on the colors, textures, shapes, smells, and flavors of food
• Integrate activities associated with food discovery into daily activities, organized activities, and educational outings

Eating well and moving enough have many benefits on the overall development and health of the child. CPE Concordia promotes the overall development of children aged 0 to 5 through healthy eating, active play, and motor development. A child who is exposed daily to nutritious, good-tasting foods enjoyed in a pleasant atmosphere in the presence of meaningful adults is more likely to associate healthy eating with positive experiences, and thus develop a taste for healthy eating.
Healthy eating respects the rules of hygiene, safety, and food safety. It is also free of allergens to protect people who are sensitive to them. In addition to their nutritional value, foods convey gastronomic, cultural, or emotional value. Indeed, it is the whole dimension of pleasure associated with meals which allows us to derive satisfaction from them, which contributes to health in its broadest sense. The positive experience can be promoted in different ways: the locations and atmosphere of pleasant meals, respect for cultural preferences, good memories associated with certain foods, etc. Healthy eating also means that food is available in quantity.

The cyclical menu

Using a 4-week cyclical menu ensures the presence of a wide variety of foods. This type of menu also allows for repeated exposure, thus encouraging familiarization and appreciation of several foods. In fact, a child must be exposed on average between 5 and 15 times to a food before discovering if they really like it.
Furthermore, the cyclical menu is an excellent management tool. It allows the person who designs it to visualize all the foods offered, and thus ensure the daily supply of foods with high nutritional value, and the less frequent offering of second-hand foods.

Preferred Practice

- Offer children aged 18 months to 5 years daily meals composed of foods from the four groups of Canada's Food Guide
- Offer two nutritious snacks each day consisting of at least two of the four groups in Canada's Food Guide
- Offer children aged 2 to 5 years a diet every day that meets at least 50% of their daily nutritional needs: At least 2 to 2 ½ servings of varied vegetables and fruits, preferably dark green or orange in color:
- At least 1 ½ to 2 servings of varied grain products, half or more of which are in the form of whole grains.
- At least 1 serving of milk and various alternatives, avoiding dairy products containing low fat.
- At least ½ serving of various meats and alternatives, including at least one dish consisting of fish and one dish consisting of vegetables or tofu each week.
- Plan and follow a cyclical menu that ensures the quality and variety of the food offering (snacks, meals, and desserts)
- Prepare foods in a tasty and attractive way, by harmonizing flavors as well as arranging colors, textures, and shapes.
- Favor milk and water as drinks to offer regularly to children.
- Encourage children to drink water to promote optimal hydration.
- Give children access to water.

Food allergies

The presence of food allergies is increasingly common and requires constant vigilance on the part of educational staff and food managers. All foods containing protein can cause potentially dangerous allergic reactions in sensitive children. The ten substances most associated with food allergies and allergic-type reactions are: peanuts, tree nuts, sesame seeds, soy, milk, eggs, seafood (fish, crustaceans, and shellfish), mustard, wheat and other cereal grains containing gluten as well as sulphites XVI. At the discretion of daycare services, a policy of excluding certain allergens may be adopted depending on their clientele.

Nuts and Peanuts are Prohibited.

PREFERRED PRACTICES FOR CHILDREN WITH FOOD ALLERGIES

• Establish a protocol to recognize allergens, ensure the safety of allergic children and intervene appropriately in the event of an allergic reaction.
• Establish a protocol to minimize risks and intervene appropriately in the event of choking.

• Avoid serving honey or products containing honey to children under 12 months
• Avoid serving the following foods: unpasteurized fruit juices, raw milk, raw milk cheese, raw eggs, raw or undercooked sprouts, raw or undercooked meats, poultry, and fish
• Offer water or milk to children after eating a sweet, sticky food
• Have safe equipment adapted to the child's age and stage of development
• No food allowed in the CPE. Wash your hands and those of your children before entering class.
For chronic allergies. You must have two epinephrine auto-injectors.

Snacks

Two snacks are served each day (morning and afternoon) in a calm and relaxed atmosphere that promotes verbal interaction between educators and children. The snacks are prepared in CPE. Objectives of snacks: provide children with healthy foods, teach them how to eat well and encourage them to become independent so they can eat without help. Occasionally, they prepare their own snacks as part of a culinary activity.

Lunch

Lunch is served every day between 11:30 and 11:50 and is provided by the Evoo Sante catering service. They follow Canada's dietary guidelines and are approved by an independent dietitian. They are extremely vigilant regarding food intolerances and allergies. All allergenic meals are carefully labeled to avoid accidents.

N.B. It is strictly forbidden to bring any types of food into the Center.

Nap

Sleep contributes significantly to the physical and mental health of young children and plays an essential role in their learning and in the consolidation of information in their memory. Sleep is involved in the regulation of emotions, which facilitates the establishment of harmonious relationships with peers, the resolution of interpersonal conflicts and the child's investment in play.

The children nap on camp beds after lunch. For this purpose, the CPE provides a cotton fitted sheet for each child's camp bed. You can bring a stuffed toy that will only be used during naptime, which lasts:

- Toddlers: 2 hours
- Children aged 2 and 3: 1 hour and a half.

- Children aged 4: 1 hour. For children aged 4 who do not need to sleep, we encourage rest and calm play ten minutes before rest time ends. There is no obligatory nap.

Group activities

Group activities are used to discover new games, new songs, etc. They promote the learning and development of new and varied skills: gross motor skills, intellectual skills, and social skills. We therefore offer several, particularly in the areas of painting, music, theater, and games.

Educators must use their skills as organizers and facilitators when it comes to planning activities around weekly, and or monthly themes. They try, as much as possible, to hold each child's attention while encouraging them to finish what they start.

Indoor activities replace outdoor activities in the event of rain or extreme cold. The wind factor is also considered when deciding whether it is too cold to go out. Otherwise, all children go out twice a day, without exception. If your child is too sick to play outside, he or she is too sick to be at the CPE and must be kept at home. Additionally, if an educator must stay indoors with a child, the ratio of educator to child outside is reduced.

- -10 degrees C. (including wind factor) for Ducklings, Busy Bees and Ladybugs
- -15 degrees C. (including wind factors) for Teddy Bears, Butterfly, Penguin

Free Play

The time allocated for free play allows the child to determine what he wants to do. We provide educational materials, toys, and games within reach. Spaces dedicated to storage are clearly defined to encourage him to put everything back in place after each activity.

Free play has several objectives. The child can freely explore the room and choose activities and friends. He can also decide to read, draw alone, or play in a small group. During this time, every morning, the educator welcomes parents/guardians and children to promote integration into the new group, pays attention to each child, observes, and identifies the progress made and communicates with the parents/guardians.

This is the time when children of different ages can play together. Then the educator arrives, gathers the children in their group and takes them to their classroom for the day.

Thanks to their skills and expertise, the educators guide the children's games and collect, by observing them, essential information to support them in their activities. It provides them with what they need to play games of all kinds and suit everyone's tastes and possibilities. It supports children and encourages them throughout the day, in the games they have always played as in the new games they imagine, and indirectly guides the knowledge that a child draws from a situation. in which he himself is involved.

Program

Typical day schedule:

7:30 a.m. – 9:00 a.m./9:30	Free play/use of toilet
9 a.m. – 11 a.m.	Snack/gym or outdoor activity (children 18 months to 2 years old) Morning snack/program – Bilingual thematic circle/learning Centers (children aged 3 and 4) snack/program (children aged 3 to 4)
11 a.m. – noon	Morning program – Bilingual thematic circle/learning centers (children from 18 months to 2 years). Use of the toilet/outdoor activity/gym (children aged 3 and 4).
11:30 a.m. – 2:30 p.m.	Meal/story/use of bathroom/nap (all ages). Wake up/use the bathroom/snack (children 18 months to 2 years)
2 p.m. – 4 p.m.	Outdoor activity or gym (all ages) Snack (children aged 3 and 4)
3:45 p.m. – 5:15 p.m.	Afternoon program – thematic circle/learning centers (all ages)
5:15 p.m. – 6 p.m.	Free play/quiet activities

The children's daily program includes:

Circle activities: based on themes designed to promote and develop social, language, motor, and intellectual skills, they can include group activities such as discussions, games, songs, hand games, poems, stories, etc.

Learning centers: set up in classrooms, these centers cover various areas such as drama, books, science, art, construction games, mathematics, and manipulatives. These areas promote learning through peer interaction, cooperation, educator-child interaction, personal exploration, and play.

Outdoor games: Children have the privilege of playing, twice a day, in a fully equipped play area with a wide variety of experiences, which promote healthy physical activity and improve the different areas of gross motor development. The courtyard includes a multi-sports area (soccer, baseball, basketball), climber, monkey bars, sandbox, water jets, water play area, cycle path, small hill, seesaw, climbing, running, hopping, playing ball, etc. The more children develop and master these skills, the more they gain confidence. Additionally, these activities allow them to get some fresh air and exercise. All outdoor play equipment and structures must be appropriate for the age of the children and meet the Canadian Standards Association standard for play areas and equipment.

Preferred Practices

- Play outside more than once a day, regardless of the season and temperature
- Plan outdoor activities in diverse places so that children can have varied motor and sensory experiences
- Encourage active travel during outings carried out near the childcare environment
- Ask parents to bring a change of clothes suitable for different climatic conditions
- Refer to standards on climatic conditions to plan outdoor outings

Interior Games: Children benefit from a very large and accessible gym space in case they cannot play outside due to bad weather or any other unforeseen event. The gym is equipped with a wide variety of equipment that improves their overall motor development. Children have access to balls, tricycles, parachutes, tunnels, large building blocks, hoops, jump rope, beams, balance boards, scooters, basketball hoops, hockey, and football equipment, jumping balloons, etc.
The layout of the premises is desirable to stimulate the child's development. Thus, the layout must allow children to have direct contact with the material: choose it, handle it, and put it away. In short, allow movement and play initiated by the child. The material, in general, must be within sight and reach of children, be classified to encourage play, be stored in bins accessible to children and be arranged to suggest games to toddlers (stacked blocks or placed in a circle).

Support for active play

Supporting active play requires sustained observation by the educational staff to provide the child with new elements, play objects and materials that allow them to achieve new motor skills. Support for active play can be based on a spontaneous educational intervention, triggered, or inspired by the situation that arises (during a game undertaken or initiated by the child). Spontaneous intervention around active play is not synonymous with "letting it happen" or "simple supervision" of children by educational staff, particularly during periods of outdoor play. This type of intervention requires as much preparation as a planned intervention because we must regularly reflect on the children's needs and areas of interest. We must also be

able to adapt to the various forms of play undertaken freely by the child, with all the creativity that we recognize in them, to awaken and actualize their potential. Support for active play can also be based on an educational intervention planned and organized according to objectives to be achieved, or a center of interest to be developed (during play directed or prompted by the adult). The planned intervention allows the child to repeat a newly learned action to facilitate its consolidation, for example throwing an object towards a target like a game of throwing sandbags in hoops. For guided games, the instructions must be brief, attractive, and clear. These games are not intended to test children's abilities, but to enrich their experiences180. However, overly busy, and inflexible daily routines should be avoided, and children should be encouraged as much as possible to take the initiative in their own active play. The play initiated by the child is gradually replaced by structured activities.

Socialization: is done by participating in organized activities and games: imaginative games, grouping of children of different ages, cooperation, taking turns during organized games. Prosocial skills (i.e. the ability to share, take turns and cooperate) are encouraged through small group activities (of children of the same age or different ages), games imagination and construction games. In addition, activities including the whole group such as organized games, discussions, songs, and motor activities allow children to develop and practice their interpersonal skills.

Outdoor activities: promote respect for nature: planting, picnicking, apple picking, making/observing bird feeders, decorating trees, observing insects, painting, and drawing.

Bilingual program: CPE Concordia offers a bilingual program to all groups. French and English aims to accustom your child to the sounds and vocabulary of the French and English languages and to make them appreciate learning a new language. When the children gather in a circle (in French or English), they discuss the theme of the week. Their songs, their games and the books read by the educator relate to the chosen theme. Several learning centers are set up in the classroom to encourage them to learn and help them gain independence and self-confidence (giving them the opportunity to make choices, decisions, and responsibilities, to show initiative, etc.). Throughout the day, they have many opportunities to express themselves in French and English at their own pace.

Recreational outings: occupying an important place in the CPE Concordia program, they allow children to explore their surroundings by going to the library, parks, and walking in the neighborhood. On longer excursions, children take part in seasonal activities like apple picking and trick-or-treating. They also go to the theater. Carefully planned by CPE Concordia staff, these outings are fantastic learning opportunities for little ones and give parents/guardians the opportunity to have an enriching experience with their children and the group.

Educational outings: where children cannot go on foot, we charter a bus so that they can travel in complete safety. We carry a first aid bag including a first aid kit, the telephone numbers of the CPE resource people and information on the children. Volunteer parents/guardians are welcome and must comply with the Center's regulations during these outings. For example, during walks, children must hold the hand of an adult. These rules are different from those that children must follow with their own parents/guardians, but they can begin to understand the dissimilar expectations. Because we care for many children, our safety policies may be stricter than those of a parent or guardian.

Daily integration of movement

In addition to play periods, both indoors and outdoors, movement can be integrated into several moments during a day in childcare. Many sedentary activities are essential to the overall development of the child, such as reading, drawing, board games, etc. However, it is advisable not to extend their duration, to intersperse them with activities or games that require more of the muscles or to energize them when possible, for example by carrying out activities standing at the coffee table, on your knees, on one leg, on tiptoe, sitting on a ball... in short, according to the limits of your imagination, and while respecting the needs of the children.

Preferred Practices

• Avoid prolonging activities of a more sedentary nature
• Intersperse sedentary activities with activities that cause greater energy expenditure
• Energize sedentary activities and transitional activities
• Involve children in tasks, according to their ability
• Avoid using television, screens, or audiovisual equipment

Ratios: CPE Concordia maintains small group sizes and a low ratio of educators per child to preserve the quality of childcare and programming at the Center.

Age of children Ratios Group size

Children's Ages	Ratios	Group Size
18 months to 2.01 years	1 to 5	9
2.02 to 2.08 years	1 to 6	12
2.09 to 3.03 years	1 to 7	13
3.04 to 3.10 years	1 to 7	15
3.11 to 4.04 years	1 to 8	15
4.05 to 4.11 years	1 to 8	16

(The ratio required by the Ministry of Families and Seniors is 1:8 for children aged 18 months to 3 years, and 1:10 for children aged 4 and over).

EDUCATOR POSITION DESCRIPTION AND CONDITIONS OF EMPLOYMENT
Program
The educator must:

• Set clear goals and objectives that reflect the needs of the children in your group.
• Develop, plan, and deliver a thematic program that stimulates children's cognitive, emotional, social and physical development, meets their needs and is age appropriate.
• All lesson plans must be submitted to the Director and Assistant Director, including a monthly self-assessment of the program.
• Maintain flexibility within the program and consider each child's individual strengths and limitations.
• Evaluate the program periodically and make necessary changes.
• Maintain frequent communication with the co-educator to ensure consistency and a well-balanced program.
• Use diverse materials to ensure the program is implemented well.
• Prepare activities in advance.
• You are entitled to thirty minutes of preparation time per day to prepare an educational program suitable for all the children in your group, assess the children, prepare for meetings with parents, colleagues, deal with children's problems, etc. Preparation times must be carried out. In the space allocated the 'preparation room' which has been designed to facilitate this very important task. Any changes in your preparation time must be reported to the principals or assistant principals.
• Ensure that the program promotes autonomy and independence.
Submit the annual or semester program in writing to the director and parents. Post weekly, bi-weekly, or monthly activities outside of class for parents to see.
• During the Co-Educators academic program (circle time), ensure children with special needs are supported, work on children's journals, always be available.
• During naptime, work on the child's observations in preparation for the children's assessments.
• Educators are responsible for providing parents with a periodic portrait of their child's progress in the areas of cognitive, emotional, physical and language development in May and November of each year. They are responsible for organizing meetings with each parent to discuss the evaluation of their child. Its content is based on observations made daily in daycare. These meetings promote partnership between educators and parents and offer strategies to support each other if the child is experiencing difficulties. Ongoing meetings are recommended if the child or parent requires additional support and there is consistency and regular follow-up. Educators will be available if a parent needs support or has a concern about their child.

Children

The educator must:

• Use a loving and consistent approach to develop the child's self-esteem, confidence, self-control, and independence.

• Approach children as sensitive, thoughtful individuals and interact with them on their own level.

• Always consider the individuality of each child in terms of their interests, strengths, limitations, learning style and pace.

• Treat each child impartially.

• Encourage and guide conflict resolution by giving children the tools to deal with difficult situations.

• Promote and be a role model in positive health and hygiene habits and encourage awareness of good health practices (physical, mental, dental, and nutritional).

• Maintain a balance between the rights of the individual child and those of the group.

Environment

The educator must:

- Create a warm, inviting, and welcoming environment.
- Create a safe, secure, and comfortable environment by arranging equipment, toys and materials in a neat and organized manner to minimize hazards.
- Always provide appropriate supervision, especially during outdoor play, center time, transitions, toilet routines, etc. Circulation in the playground, gymnasium and classroom will ensure the safety of children.
- Provide a stimulating/learning environment that reflects the needs of the whole child by:
- Use space, materials (including gym equipment) and routines as resources to build an interesting and enjoyable environment that encourages exploration and learning.
- Promote a healthy environment and promote good health by:
- Wash equipment, toys, and furniture four (4) times a year; disinfect toys after lice, gastro, or any other communicable disease or epidemic.
- Wash the sheets, at least every two weeks.
- Disinfection zone immediately after accidents.
- Clean children's compartments regularly and throw away plastic bags.
- Make sure all hazardous cleaning products are always locked away.
- Health and security
- The educator must:
- Ensure that children are well always supervised inside and outside the center by:
- Always maintain ratios.
- Never leave a child alone.
- Do not leave an educator alone in the playground with the children.

- There should be at least two (2) educators with one (1) group, three (3) educators with two (2) groups and four (4) educators with three (3) groups and eight (8) educators with the entire Center.
- Never leave children alone with a trainee, volunteer, or visitor.
- Always be vigilant, watch out for possible dangers and try to prevent them.
- Report any suspicious strangers to the director.
- Always know the exact number of children in your group throughout the day and always know where they are.
- Be aware of and follow evacuation procedures (see Personnel Policies Section Four).
- Obtain and maintain first aid qualifications.

• Report any illness and accident to parents and the principal or vice-principal.
• Complete an accident report when necessary.
• In the event of head trauma, parents must be called immediately.
• Be informed of internal policies regarding childhood illnesses, as well as procedures and guidelines regarding medication administration.
• Report any concerns regarding suspected child abuse to the principal and document any incidents or situations.
• When a child is absent for three consecutive days, the educator must inform the administrative assistant who will call the parents.
• Follows pick-up procedures (see CPE Concordia Policy Manual).
• Understand that school trips are only undertaken when group ratios are respected. The educator must bring their own Medicare number and a list of the children's Medicare numbers. An emergency fund of twenty dollars ($20) will be given to the educator. Field visit procedures must always be followed (see Personnel Policies Section Four).
• Refer to a red emergency binder containing all relevant materials regarding children's information, emergency contacts and pickup authorization. These red emergency binders are in the office and in the main room. Any anomaly must be reported immediately to the office. A list of changes to this information should also be checked.
• Make sure their clothing does not endanger their safety or that of children.
• No hot drinks in the classroom, playground, or gymnasium.

Relationships with children

The educator must:

• Always put the needs of children first.
• Be a positive role model at all times, treating each child equally and with respect.
• Maintain confidentiality when discussing children with others.
• Respect the individuality of each child.
• Be warm, responsive, and caring to each child and provide them with a sense of security.
• Make yourself available to the child.
• Encourage children in your care to adopt good, healthy eating habits.

Relationship with parents
The educator must:
• Maintain an open, friendly, and informative relationship with each child's family.
• Be open and available to concerns, questions, etc. parents.
• Involve the parent(s) in their child's developmental progress and keep them informed.
• Address the parent(s) with any concerns in a positive and constructive manner.
• Always work with parents to find the best possible solution to difficult situations. Be professional at all times by being diplomatic, courteous and considerate when interacting with parents.
• Treat each parent with respect.
• Demonstrate sensitivity to diversity based on family structure, background, beliefs and religious practices.
• Encourage parents to get involved in the center environment (e.g. volunteering, special activities).

Relations with other employees, interns, volunteers, specialists, and visitors
The educator must:
• Maintain an open, professional, and respectful relationship with everyone within the Center.
• Communicate with others in a positive and constructive manner.
• Work cooperatively and in solidarity with others.
• Children of employees accessing the Center must be accompanied by the educator, parent (adult) always. The visiting child should never be alone with children in a group and should not be responsible for implementing and completing employee tasks or duties. Regarding other visitors such as grandparents, uncles, aunts, etc., the same policy applies.

General standards of professionalism
The educator must:
•To be punctual.
• Always behave in a professional manner.
• Dedicate yourself to the success of the program.
• Continue their growth and development as professionals by attending workshops/conferences, setting goals and objectives to achieve each year and evaluating them throughout the year.
• Make sure their clothing is appropriate and suitable for working with children.
• Be a positive role model when interacting with children.
• Be a positive role model for volunteers, interns, specialists, and visitors.
• Attend all regular team meetings.
• Cell phones or any other devices should not be used during work hours, including nap times. They must be closed and locked with your personal belongings (in your locker) during the work period. They are a huge distraction and 100% of your attention should always be on the children. Your cooperation is very important to

the safety and well-being of every child. All personal calls should be made during your break only. If you need to make an urgent call, make arrangements with the office. Inform your family of the procedures to follow in the event of an emergency. For special emergencies, consult Maria or Tina.

• The Center voluntarily provides coffee and tea to its employees during breaks or before the start of your shift. There are no coffee or tea breaks during working hours, especially when working directly with children.